



Infrastructure Governance Guide for Regulated Organizations

How managed infrastructure is the foundation of every enforceable governance program.

Why Infrastructure Is Governance

In regulated environments, governance policies are only enforceable through managed infrastructure:

- Unmanaged devices cannot enforce encryption, patching, or access controls.
- Unmonitored networks cannot detect unauthorized access or data exfiltration.
- Shadow IT undermines every compliance control in place.
- Regulatory examiners expect documented evidence of infrastructure controls.
- Governance without managed infrastructure is documentation without enforcement.

Endpoint Governance

Every device accessing organizational data must be managed:

- ✓ Device Enrollment: MDM/UEM enrollment for all endpoints (Windows, Mac, mobile).
- ✓ Patch Management: Automated patching within defined SLAs (critical: 48 hours).
- ✓ Disk Encryption: BitLocker/FileVault enforced and verified through MDM.
- ✓ Application Control: Approved software inventory with installation controls.
- ✓ Endpoint Detection: EDR deployment with 24/7 monitoring and response.
- ✓ Asset Lifecycle: Provisioning, monitoring, and secure decommissioning procedures.

Network & Cloud Infrastructure

Network architecture must support governance requirements:

- Managed firewalls with documented rulesets and change management.
- Network segmentation isolating sensitive data and systems.
- Secure remote access through managed VPN or ZTNA.
- Cloud infrastructure with enforced security baselines.
- DNS filtering and web content controls.
- Network monitoring with anomaly detection and alerting.

Implementation Checklist

- Enroll all endpoints in MDM/UEM management platform
- Deploy automated patch management with compliance reporting
- Enforce disk encryption on all endpoints with key escrow
- Implement managed backup with tested recovery procedures
- Deploy identity platform with MFA and conditional access
- Configure managed firewalls with documented security policies
- Establish network monitoring with SOC integration
- Document infrastructure governance policies and procedures

Governance Reporting

Infrastructure governance requires ongoing reporting:

- Monthly infrastructure compliance dashboards for leadership.
- Quarterly governance reviews with documented findings and remediation.
- Annual infrastructure risk assessments aligned with regulatory requirements.
- Incident reporting with root cause analysis and control improvements.
- Audit-ready documentation maintained continuously, not created before exams.
- Board-level infrastructure governance reporting on a quarterly basis.